

Assignment 1

Portfolio Entry Page



GOALS

This first assignment is meant to lead, each student, to having their own portfolio for the designs created throughout the semester.

The purpose of this assignment is to:

- Learn about HTML/CSS/JavaScript for UI development
- Learn about hosting a website
- Learn about presenting your work in a portfolio
- Put in practice principles of Visual Communication

At this stage of the semester, we have not learned all the principles for UI/UX design which should be incorporated into your portfolio. Still, we are exploring elements of visual communication that should guide some of your design choices. Do not see this portfolio as static. If you wish to modify it later in the semester, you are welcome to do so. Here is your chance to do a first attempt.

Please note:

This portfolio will serve throughout the semester, as you will link it to each new design/website that you create.

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SCHEDULE / DEADLINES

Here are the important calendar events for this assignment.

- **Monday, May 11th tutorial**

Make sure to attend May 11th tutorial in which you will further explore the requirements for this assignment and the required technologies.

The following Monday, May 18th, is a holiday, and we will not have any tutorials in that week. You will already have enough to explore.

- **Forum monitoring on Brightspace between May 12 and May 22**

If something is not clear, if you need help about the assignment, then please ask questions on Brightspace forum. Make sure you get help. Any question is fine, as long as it is asked in a polite and respectful manner. TAs will be monitoring the forum regularly and answer your questions. Not only will their answers help you, they will help other students in the class.

- **Emails to TAs between May 12 and May 22 (if needed)**

ONLY if the forum help is not sufficient, you can request a one-on-one help session from the TA assigned to your lab session (make sure you contact the TA for YOUR session – Z01 to Z04).

- **Report submission: Sunday, May 24th, midnight**

You MUST submit your report, which will contain a link to your portfolio by Sunday, May 24th. *No extension will be given. The only exceptions will be for justified medical reasons with medical certificates. The penalty is 20% per day. There is a grace period till 1am... but then it's -20%!*

- **Group review registration: Sunday, May 24th, midnight**

Make sure you put your name on the group review schedule. You MUST participate in the group review to practice your analysis skills and get feedback on your design.

- **Group review participation between May 25th and June 3rd**

Your scheduled group review session will be within 10 days of your submission. Not registering or missing the group review is 20% off your assignment.



Web development technologies

To be able to develop and host your portfolio, here are some links to various tutorials.



Tutorial on HTML: <https://www.w3schools.com/html/default.asp>

Tutorial on CSS: <https://www.w3schools.com/css/default.asp>

Tutorial on JavaScript: <https://www.w3schools.com/js/default.asp>

Tutorial on Bootstrap 5: <https://www.w3schools.com/bootstrap5/index.php>

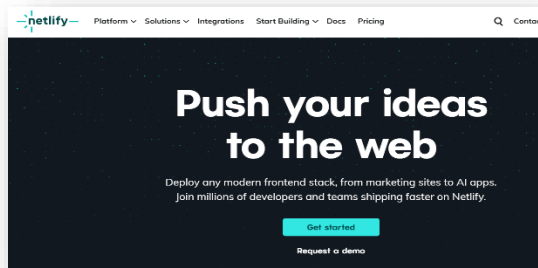
It seems like a lot, but you don't have to go through all the tutorials. I suggest you look a bit at what is HTML/CSS. Then, look a bit at the plain JavaScript to have an idea of how to program with it. But really, where you need to go is to the Bootstrap tutorial, since Bootstrap contains many ready-made UI components that you will need.

There is also Net Ninja, that I highly recommend. The author offers tutorials on HTML, CSS, JavaScript and Bootstrap (among many). See [Net Ninja video tutorial on Bootstrap 5](#). This person explains well.

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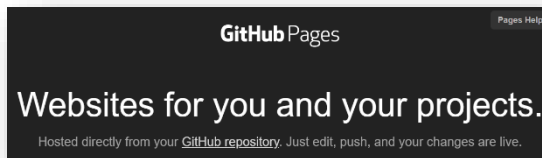
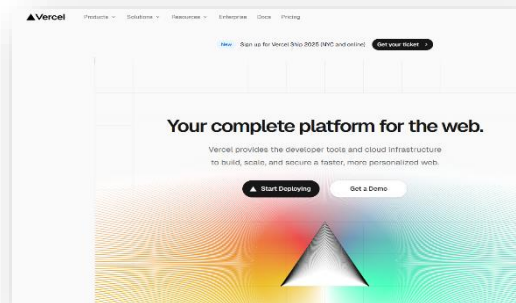
Web site hosting

For the hosting of your web site UI, you have several options.



[Netlify](#): easily connect your GitHub repository and Netlify will build and host your site. Supports custom domains. Watch [this video](#) to learn how to deploy your website on Netlify.

[Vercel](#): another popular platform for deploying UI applications. It integrates easily with GitHub. Like Netlify, it provides custom domain support. Watch [this video](#) to learn how to deploy your website on Vercel.



[GitHub Pages](#): There are step by step instructions on the site to be able to get your public repository that will be hosted at `username.github.io`. You can also watch [this video](#).

You may use any of these platforms (or another hosting service you find) to deploy your website. Last year, most students used Netlify and Vercel. Students had a bit more difficulty with GitHub pages, especially for dynamic website using React which we develop later in the semester.

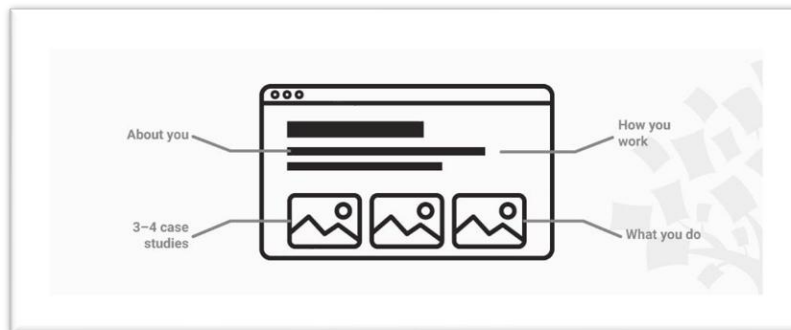
Make sure the final version is publicly accessible so the TA can access and test your UI.



REQUIREMENTS

1. Design and create your portfolio

In that blog, [What should a UX Design Portfolio Contain?](#), from the Interaction Design Foundation, the author mentions 3 important components of your portfolio as seen in the image below.



Your portfolio should contain these 3 sections:

- a. About you:
 - Who you are, what you like. You can include a photo of yourself if you wish, or only put your name and information about yourself.
- b. How you work:
 - If you already have experience as a designer, explain your workflow.
 - If you don't have any experience, this section should indicate that you are currently taking a UI design course and learning design elements as part of the course. You can provide links to your course and other sites (e.g. the NN/g site we're using as a reference).
 - Later in the semester, you will need to add the various concepts you use to demonstrate your expertise (e.g., user-centered design, heuristic evaluation, etc.) and your design process.
- c. 4 case studies:
 - By the end of the semester, you will have 4 case studies to show, as we will do 4 additional assignments, each leading to a design/prototype.
 - For now, include 4 images, as links to your future designs, and include a hold page ("coming soon" or other) for each one. Choose the images according to the future required designs (you can change these images later):
 - Design 1: a service site (e.g. dentist, bike repair, hairdresser)
 - Design 2: un jeu de mémoire
 - Design 3: an e-commerce site
 - Design 4: an analytics site (BI, sport, anything with visualization).

Your design choices, as guided by visual communication principles, should reflect who you are:

- a. As much as we will focus later in the semester on *User Centered Design* to make sure your designs correspond to the needs of users other than you... this time, for a portfolio, it is ALL about YOU.
- b. Make sure the style reflects who you are. We are seeing principles of visual communication during the video lectures (ours and the ones from NN/g), so you need to explore how these principles can be used to generate a portfolio entry page that will make future employers get to know you, in a short amount of time. How do you want the future employers to think about you? Your portfolio is a reflection of yourself.

2. Host your portfolio on a platform

Your website UI should be accessible to the public (or, if you prefer, password protected with the password provided in your report). The TA must be able to access your UI without having to communicate with you.

Also, during your group review, you **MUST** show your website as hosted and publicly accessible.

This is IMPORTANT. If you do not know how to host a website, make sure you attend the tutorials and ask for help.

3. Write a short report describing design choices you made:

The purpose of the report is to explain some of your choices in relation to the theory explored during the videos on Visual communication.

1. Name, student number, report title.
2. Your previous experience in JavaScript development, and what you did as tutorial videos/readings to acquire the necessary skills to do the current project.
3. Provide links to at least 3 portfolio sites that have inspired you, either positively (liked) or negatively (disliked). Explain why they inspired you in one way or another.
4. A link to your UI (on Github pages or other hosting site).
5. A link to your Bootstrap code (on Github or other accessible development site).
6. A description of your design choices in relation to visual communication:
 - a. Colors
 - i. What palette did you choose and why?
 - b. Typography
 - i. What fonts did you choose and why?
 - c. Screen Layout
 - i. Describe your layout and how it incorporates the principles of Scale, Visual Hierarchy, Balance and Contrast (see NN/g videos).



EVALUATION

This assignment is worth 5%

- Your report's content and clarity (20%)
 - Report easy to read and answers the required questions.
 - Go through the list of 6 elements given above. Your report should contain all of these elements with answers to better understand your design choices.
- Your hosted web site, accessible and made according to the requirements provided (60%)
 - UI should reflect the choices made for visual communication
 - UI should include all required components (about you, your work, links to 4 future designs)
- Your active participation in the group review (20%)
 - Ability to analyze other student's design according to the principles explored in the lecture
 - Ability to answer questions from TA and other students



SUBMISSION CONTENT / PLATFORM

Each student (it is an individual assignment) must submit their report, PDF version (see all its requirements above) on Brightspace. The link can be found in the Assignment section, for Assignment 1.

ALSO, very important, **MAKE SURE you register on the signup sheet for your group review.** An announcement will be posted when the signup sheet is available.



QUESTIONS

- See the section Schedule/Deadline of the current document. It indicates tutorials and forum for help and questions.
- Please DO NOT send the professor any emails. The forum help should be enough to obtain answers to your questions. Do not be shy to ask questions on the forum. Any answers provided there by the TA will help many other students.
- If the forum help is not sufficient, email the TA assigned to your lab session.